# KYLE WILLEMS

CYBERSECURITY | SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATION | IT SUPPORT | INFORMATION ASSURANCE

linkedin.com/in/kyle-willems

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

**Cybersecurity · Systems Administration · IT Support**

Army Sergeant bringing hands-on cybersecurity training, disciplined troubleshooting, and team leadership to cybersecurity and IT roles. Earned CompTIA Security+ and A+ certifications.

Lab and personal project work spans SOC engineering, Linux and Windows administration, vulnerability assessment, networking, scripting, and technical documentation.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Systems & networking labs:** Ubuntu Server, Kali Linux, Windows, Active Directory, VMware; users and groups, permissions, services, logs, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, SSH, VLANs, 802.1Q, IPv4 subnetting, and Cisco Packet Tracer.

**Security tools & investigations:** Wazuh, Splunk, Elastic, Wireshark, Nmap, Nessus, Burp Suite, MITRE ATT&CK Navigator, and VirusTotal; lab alert triage, packet analysis, file integrity monitoring, Registry persistence, and reporting.

**Applications & scripting labs:** Apache, Flask APIs, HTTPS/TLS, Docker, Nginx, and Jenkins CI/CD; Bash account provisioning, PowerShell reports and SHA-256 checks, and Python fundamentals.

**Risk & assurance labs:** NIST SP 800-53, Risk Management Framework (RMF), system security plans (SSPs), and plans of action and milestones (POA&Ms); simulated risk assessments, likelihood and impact scoring, and mitigation planning.

**Basic or conceptual familiarity:** Red Hat Enterprise Linux, VirtualBox, OpenVAS, AWS fundamentals, IAM, least privilege, CIS Controls, STIG/SCAP, EDR concepts, YARA syntax, and secure SDLC.

## CYBERSECURITY TRAINING & LABS

**RapidAscent — Cybersecurity Analyst Trainee** | Remote · July–October 2026

Full-time, lab-based cybersecurity training with an approximately 800-hour curriculum covering systems administration, SOC operations, network security, cloud concepts, and incident response.

- SOC engineering project: contributed by deploying Wazuh on Ubuntu, hardening service access, validating Windows/Linux telemetry and detections, enabling PowerShell logging, and integrating Yamcs application logs into the dashboard.
- Managed Linux users, groups, and shared-directory permissions; tested authorized and denied access, analyzed system and service logs, diagnosed permission errors, and practiced Windows/Active Directory administration.
- Used Nmap and Nessus in labs. Configured VLANs, trunks, and inter-VLAN routing in Packet Tracer; completed subnetting exercises and verified UFW access and logging policies.
- Analyzed simulated Wazuh, Splunk, and Elastic events and packet captures. Documented findings and incident response workflows; deployed Nginx in Docker and practiced Jenkins workflows.
- Provisioned accounts using Bash; generated system reports and compared SHA-256 hashes in PowerShell; completed Python programming exercises and generated timestamped simulated user activity.
- Contributed to a simulated aerospace/defense risk assessment, including assets, threats, likelihood and impact scoring, mitigation priorities, SSPs, and POA&Ms.

**TryHackMe — Independent Cybersecurity Labs** | Ongoing · Guided training

Completed 93 rooms covering SOC operations, systems administration, network analysis, and vulnerability assessment as of November 2026. The SOC Level 1 learning path remains in progress.

- Completed SOC labs in SIEM monitoring, security event analysis, EDR fundamentals, alert triage, escalation, reporting, and investigation workbooks and lookups.
- Practiced Linux and Windows hardening; examined Linux file systems for attacker artifacts and investigated Registry persistence with the AutoRuns PowerShell module.
- Practiced vulnerability identification, assessment, mitigation, and reporting; used Nmap for guided scanning and discovery. Studied Kerberos attacks, Burp Suite, YARA syntax, and secure SDLC.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**U.S. Army | Sergeant (E-5), Combat Medic (68W) | Fort Campbell, KY | September 2019–Present**

- Served as primary medical advisor for an infantry company of 150+ soldiers; coordinated medical planning, personnel, equipment, readiness requirements, evacuation planning, and risk controls for seven or more high-risk training exercises annually.
- Trained 500+ DoD personnel and interagency partners annually in medical procedures, casualty response, and performance standards; delivered instruction and evaluated readiness.
- Supervised, mentored, and evaluated 10+ personnel; prioritized workloads, coordinated treatment teams, resolved operational issues, and maintained procedural compliance in time-sensitive environments.
- Managed $300,000+ in regulated medical equipment and supplies; maintained inventory records, regulatory compliance, operational readiness, and 100% accountability.
- Delivered trauma care and evacuation coordination; followed HIPAA requirements and maintained medical, readiness, and training records. Resolved equipment, communication, supply, and procedural issues across teams supporting DoD operations.

## TECHNICAL PROJECTS

**Home SOC / Windows and Linux Security Lab** | Personal project · In progress

- Built a VMware lab with Ubuntu Server, Windows 11, and Wazuh; installed and connected a Linux agent to the manager and verified connectivity.
- Windows agent and Sysmon deployment remain in progress. Failed-login, SSH brute-force, web-enumeration, and PowerShell detection scenarios are planned.

**Ubuntu Server Business Website** | Lab project · Ubuntu Server, Apache, Python/Flask, VMware

- Deployed a lab website with Apache virtual hosts, Linux services, dependencies, permissions, and network access. Developed Flask API endpoints and configured Apache reverse proxying.
- Configured HTTPS, security headers, and firewall rules; documented troubleshooting of connectivity, certificate trust, and service configuration.

**Threat Intelligence and Malware Analysis** | Training exercises

- Created five MITRE ATT&CK Navigator layers for documented threat-group techniques and combined the layers to visualize shared behaviors.
- Collaborated on a PCAP investigation in an isolated Linux lab using Wireshark filtering, HTTP-object export, SHA-256 hashes, and VirusTotal correlation to investigate an executable disguised as a PNG.

## CERTIFICATIONS

**CompTIA Security+** | Earned · November 2026

**CompTIA A+** | Earned · July 2026

**CompTIA CySA+** | In progress · Expected December 2026

**CompTIA Linux+** | Studying · Not earned

## EDUCATION

**Western Governors University** | M.S. in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance
Accepted for a January 2027 start. Expected graduation: December 2028.

**City University of Seattle** | Undergraduate Certificate in Cybersecurity · October 2026

**University of Mississippi** | B.S. Chemistry · May 2017
Biochemistry emphasis; minor in Mathematics.